Punduma Sumndad Sani

Punduma "Duma" Sumndad Sani (born September 15, 1946), widely known as **Kaka Duma**, is a Maranao educator, martial arts grandmaster, traditional royalty, revolutionary figure, and legislator from Marawi City, Lanao del Sur.

He is a professor at Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi, the founder and longtime head of the MSU Karate Club (MSUKC), a former MNLF commander and peace process panelist, the Sultan of the Royal House of Guimba of the United Sultanates of Marawi, and a former member of the first Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) Parliament representing the MNLF sector.

Across more than five decades of public life, Sani has moved between the classroom, the training mat, the peace negotiating table, and the legislative chamber, building a reputation as one of the most multi-dimensional figures in contemporary Bangsamoro and Maranao public life.

He's the kind of person you hear about in almost every corner of Marawi: from MSU alumni who trained under him in karate, to MNLF veterans who fought alongside him, to BTA colleagues who co-authored landmark legislation with him.

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Background and Early Life

Punduma Sumndad Sani was born on September 15, 1946, in Buadi Sakayo, Marawi City, in the heart of the Maranao homeland in Lanao del Sur.

He comes from the prominent Sani Clan, a family with deep royal and political roots across Ranao, Maguindanao, and Sulu.

His father granted him the use of the maternal surname, a practical family decision that also reflects the fluid and layered nature of Maranao kinship and identity.

In 1994, Sani was formally enthroned as Sultan of the Royal House of Guimba, one of the United Sultanates of Marawi, succeeding a distinguished lineage that includes former legislators and municipal executives from the region.

He grew up attending grade school in Bangon, Marawi, before proceeding to Dansalan Junior High School for his secondary education.

Education

For college, Sani made his way to Manila and enrolled at Manuel L. Quezon University, where he earned a Bachelor of Science in Commerce, major in Business Administration, in 1968.

Returning to Mindanao, he pursued graduate studies at the University of the East, completing the academic requirements for a Master of Arts in Physical Education and passing his comprehensive examinations in 1981.

He later added another postgraduate credential at Mindanao State University itself, completing a Master of Arts in Public Administration in 1997.

This combination of commerce, physical education, and public administration training reflects the range of his professional engagements throughout his career.

The Revolutionary Years

Like many Maranao men of his generation who came of age during the turbulence of the late 1960s and the imposition of Martial Law under the Marcos regime, Sani found himself drawn into the Moro struggle for self-determination.

He underwent military training with the Moro National Liberation Front's Top 90 in Pulau Pangkor, Malaysia, one of the early elite formations of the MNLF's armed cadre.

During this period he was known in movement circles as "Commander Juma," a name that carried weight among fellow fighters and organizers in Mindanao.

What distinguished Sani during this chapter was that he never entirely abandoned his civilian roles, continuing to teach and engage with his community even while active in the resistance.

That combination of armed conviction and patient institution-building would become a defining thread throughout his life.

Prof. Punduma Sumndad Sani



Born	September 15, 1946
Birthplace	Buadi Sakayo, Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Also Known As	Kaka Duma; Commander Juma; Hanshi Sani
Title	Sultan of the Royal House of Guimba (enthroned 1994); one of the United Sultanates of Marawi
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Spouse	Hadja Faizah Minerva Alicer Saber
Children	Revie, Hanifi, Maylanie (and others)
Education	BS Commerce (Business Administration), Manuel L. Quezon University, 1968; Graduate studies in Physical Education, University of the East; MA in Public Administration, Mindanao State University, 1997
Occupation	Professor, Martial Arts Master, Parliamentarian, Community Leader

He maintained his loyalty to the MNLF's mainstream track through the decades-long peace process that eventually led to the 1996 Final Peace Agreement with the Philippine government.

His involvement in the peace negotiations was significant: he served as one of the few Maranao representatives among the MNLF panelists at the 18th Islamic Conference of Foreign Ministers held in Saudi Arabia in 1989, and participated in critical exploratory talks between the Government of the Republic of the Philippines (GRP) and the MNLF held in Indonesia.

Those Indonesian consultations were among the substantive preliminary discussions that paved the way for the 1996 agreement.

Affiliation	Mindanao State University; Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF); Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA)
Legislative role	Member, BTA Parliament (2019-2022), MNLF Representative
Martial arts rank	9th Dan; addressed as Hanshi and Kyoshi
Founded	MSU Karate Club (MSUKC), 1972; Bangsamoro Martial Arts Academy

Career at Mindanao State University

Sani's connection with Mindanao State University in Marawi goes back to the early 1970s, when he started out as an accounting clerk and part-time instructor.

He rose steadily through the academic ranks, eventually becoming a full professor, and was appointed Director of the Sports Scholarship and Development Office, a position he held from 1971 to 1987.

In 1993, he was elected by his colleagues as Dean of the College of Sports, Physical Education, and Recreation (CSPEAR), serving in that role until 1996.

His election as dean during a particularly tense period in Marawi's history is remembered as a meaningful show of confidence: Christian faculty members reportedly voted for him alongside Muslim colleagues, a small but telling sign of the trust and respect he had built across community lines.

Throughout his academic career, Sani was known as a professor who pushed students toward discipline, leadership, and community service, not just technical skills.

After his term in the BTA Parliament, he returned to the university with evident enthusiasm, continuing to teach and mentor the next generation.

The Martial Arts Legacy

Of all the chapters in Prof. Sani's life, his work in martial arts may be the most enduring in terms of institutional impact.

In 1972, he founded the MSU Karate Club (MSUKC) on the Marawi campus, and has guided the organization for more than five decades since.

He holds the rank of 9th Dan, the highest gradations in the Japanese karate tradition, and is addressed with the honorifics Hanshi and Kyoshi, titles reserved for grandmasters of advanced rank and long experience.

Under his guidance, the MSUKC has produced local, national, and international champions, run community outreach programs, and served as a consistent space for Muslim-Christian camaraderie in a city that has seen its share of tension and tragedy.

Three generations of martial artists have now trained under the club he built, including his own children: Revie, Hanifi, and Maylanie, all of whom became accomplished competitors in their own right.

He also established and continues to oversee the Bangsamoro Martial Arts Academy, extending the club's mission into a broader regional platform for developing youth through the discipline of martial arts.

For Sani, karate has never been just about sport or combat technique. He consistently frames it as a vehicle for character development, resilience, and a quiet but meaningful expression of cultural pride.

Even while serving in the BTA Parliament, he remained hands-on in the club's activities, showing up on the mats and staying connected to the athletes he has mentored.

In the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament (2019-2022)

When the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) was established following the ratification of the Bangsamoro Organic Law (Republic Act No. 11054) in 2019, Sani was appointed as one of the MNLF representatives to the inaugural BTA Parliament.

His legislative record during the BTA's three-year transitional period was notably wide-ranging.

He was a principal author or co-author of measures covering the Bangsamoro flag, emblem, and official hymn; the creation of sports and youth development commissions; planning and development bodies for the region; education reform initiatives; the establishment of women's and human rights commissions; the Bangsamoro budget and local governance codes; and resolutions focused on the rehabilitation of Marawi City following the devastating 2017 siege.

He also co-authored practical legislation on public health, internally displaced persons (IDPs), the welfare of Bangsamoro overseas workers, and the integration of former MNLF and MILF combatants into civilian life and the BARMM's security forces.

Colleagues in the BTA Parliament and constituents who followed his work describe him as principled and community-focused, someone who spoke with clarity on issues like Ranao development and the historical valor of the Bangsamoro people.

He was also among those who advocated for commemorating significant milestones in the Bangsamoro people's collective memory.

Family and Personal Values

Sani is married to Hadja Faizah Minerva Alicer Saber, daughter of the late Mamitua Saber, one of the founding pillars of Mindanao State University and a towering intellectual figure in the Maranao community.

Together, they built a family where academics and martial arts have both been passed on as living traditions, with their children carrying forward commitments to sport, discipline, and community service.

His values come through consistently in how people who know him describe him: discipline, humility, a genuine commitment to unity across ethnic and religious divides, and a deep sense of responsibility to the Bangsamoro cause that never loses sight of faith and good governance.

He has long been seen as someone who bridges worlds without pretension: traditional royalty and elected public servant, martial arts grandmaster and classroom teacher, MNLF veteran and institution-builder.

Legacy and Continuing Contributions

Now in his late seventies, Prof. Punduma B. Sani hasn't stepped back from public life in any meaningful way.

He remains active on the training mats, continues to mentor students and young community members, participates in regional initiatives, and is still regarded as a respected and authoritative voice in Maranao and Bangsamoro affairs.

His legacy rests on the breadth and consistency of what he built across more than five decades: a karate club that became a community institution, a teaching career that shaped thousands of students, a legislative contribution that helped lay the legal groundwork for the Bangsamoro government, and a life of principled engagement with some of the most difficult questions facing Mindanao.

Whether people know him as Kaka Duma, as Sultan of Guimba, as Hanshi Sani, or simply as the man who founded the MSUKC, the through-line is the same: a teacher, a fighter, a lawmaker, and a builder who led consistently by example and always kept the next generation in view.

In the story of contemporary Mindanao and the long, difficult project of building peace and self-governance in the Bangsamoro homeland, Prof. Punduma Sumndad Sani is one of the steady hands.

Recognition

- Sultan of the Royal House of Guimba, United Sultanates of Marawi (enthroned 1994)
- Founder and lifetime head coach, MSU Karate Club (MSUKC), established 1972
- 9th Dan grandmaster in karate; honorifics Hanshi and Kyoshi
- MNLF panelist, 18th Islamic Conference of Foreign Ministers, Saudi Arabia (1989)
- Dean, College of Sports, Physical Education, and Recreation, MSU Marawi (1993-1996)
- Member, First Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament (2019-2022), MNLF sector

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Bangsamoro Transition Authority
- Moro National Liberation Front
- Bangsamoro Organic Law
- United Sultanates of Marawi
- Mamitua Saber
- Marawi City

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